

Best of Osmosis

*The Card Magic
of
George McBride*

ENTER

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Email the author: geo.mcb@ntlworld.com

All From ... One

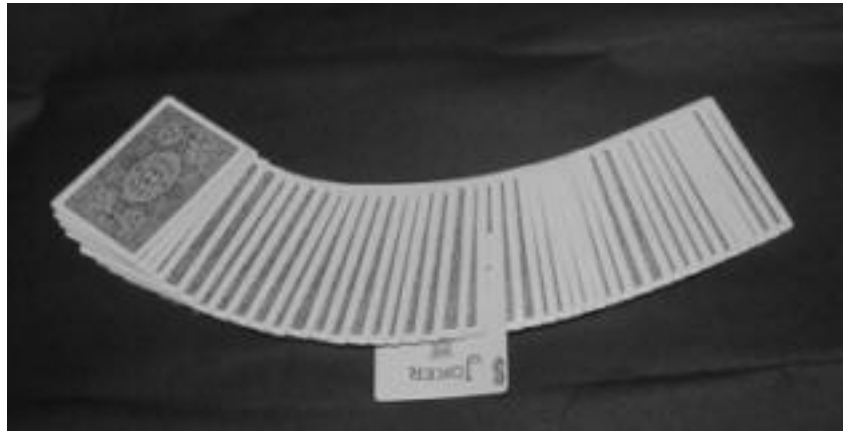
The inspiration for this trick came from a routine of Shaun McCree's that was published in *Abacus* a few years back.

In Shaun's trick a Joker was used to find three previously lost selections. With that in mind I developed the following routine.

1. Begin by removing the Joker and dropping it face up onto the table. Next, three cards are chosen either by one spectator or by three different spectators - it's up to you. The three selections have to be controlled - one to the bottom and the other two on top of the pack. I use a Multiple Shift then Double Undercut one card from top to bottom.

2. Once you have controlled the selections to the above positions, the pack is now Ribbon-spread face down across the table. At this point pick up the Joker and give it to the spectator.

He is now instructed to place the Joker face up into the spread of cards anywhere he wishes. Although he can place the Joker anywhere, try to manipulate the proceedings so that the Joker is positioned somewhere near the middle of the spread (photo).



3. The pack is now squared, picked up and placed into left hand dealing grip. The cards are re-spread face down from hand to hand. As this is being done, say, "**I will now remove the Joker and the card next to it.**" That is, the card to the left of the Joker. By this time you should have reached the face up Joker in the spread of cards. The Joker and the card apparently to its left are dropped from the spread onto the table.



What's actually happening here is:

As the Joker is being dropped from the spread the left hand is dealing the bottom card of the pack. The Joker and the bottom card land together on the table (photo). This great move belongs to Edward Marlo. (See Marlo's Bomb Door Bottom Deal).

4. The pack is now placed into left hand dealing grip. Your right hand picks up the two cards from the table and the face down one is flipped face up onto the pack. The spectator has found one of the selections by placing the Joker right next to it in the spread. As the face up selection and Joker are displayed a break is secured under the top card of the pack. The cards are squared and all three cards are picked up in right hand Biddle grip. The left thumb peels off the selection and places it under the double card in your right hand. Give the packet a snap and reveal that a second selection has been trapped between the Joker and the first selection.

5. This second selection is removed and flipped face up onto the pack. Three cards are now on display - two face up selections with a face up Joker in the middle. Flip the Joker face down leaving it in middle.

The face down Joker and the selection on its right are grasped by the right hand - they are both held at the bottom right corner. The right hand now freezes as the left hand deals the face up selection, on the left of the Joker, to the table.



The left hand now approaches the right hand cards, by which time a break has been secured under the top card of the pack by the left 3rd finger. The left thumb peels off the other selection. As this is being done the face down Joker is switched for the top card of the pack (photo). One face down card remains in your right hand and the face up selection dealt onto the table. This switch belongs to Bernard Bilis.

The left hand now approaches the right hand cards, by which time a break has been secured under

the top card of the pack by the left 3rd finger. The left thumb peels off the other selection. As this is being done the face down Joker is switched for the top card of the pack (fig.3). One face down card remains in your right hand and the face up selection dealt onto the table. This switch belongs to Bernard Bilis.

All that remains is for you to snap the face down Joker in your right hand and to show it has changed into the third selection.

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Ambitious Hofzinser

The following routine combines the "Ambitious Card" plot with that of the classic "Hofzinser Ace Problem."

1. Begin by having a card chosen. The card is replaced in the pack and controlled to the top. This should present no problem.

2. The pack is now turned face up and the four Aces are removed.

To do this, simply run through the pack and as you come to each Ace, upjog it for half its length. Also, when you are removing the Aces take this opportunity to glimpse the top card of the pack (the selection).

Once all four Aces have been upjogged, strip them out using your right hand, then turn them face down and place them under the pack.

3. The pack is now flipped over into your left hand. For this description let's say the face up Aces are in the following order from the top down - S, H, C, D. And the suit of the selected card is Clubs. The Ace of Clubs has to be manoeuvred into the 2nd Position from the top. In this case you would just have to switch the Clubs with Hearts. The order of the Aces will now be from the top down: S, C, H, D. The Aces are then casually displayed and a break is secured under the first face down card (the selection).

Square the cards take them into a right hand Biddle Grip. The pack is placed onto the table in front of you. Transfer the Ace packet into your left hand.

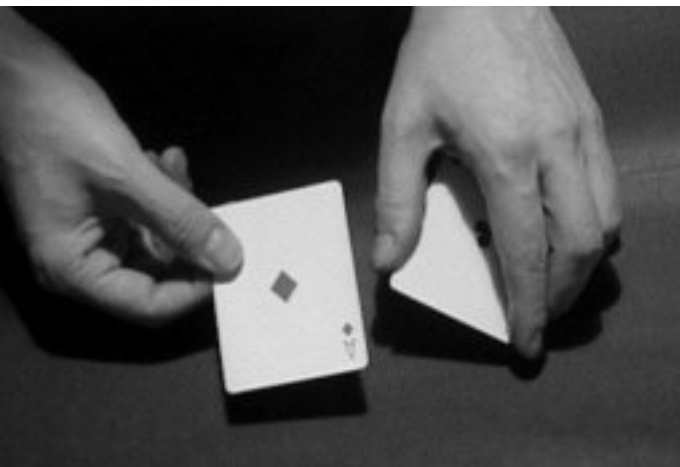
4. Ask the spectator to merely think of the SUIT of his card, saying, **"The suit of your card could be a Spade."** As this is said the right hand removes the Ace of Spades, revolves it face down and places it under the packet (photos below). This procedure is carried out with the remaining three Aces. All cards in your left hand are now face down.



5. Say, **"Let me show you an interesting way for me to discover the suit of your card."** As this is being said, execute a Double Turn-over to display the Ace of Spades. Then, turn the double face down again. Take off the top card and place it under the packet, saying, **"If the Ace of Spades rises up through the packet to the top, that tells me the suit of your card was NOT a Spade."** Flip over the top card revealing the Ace of Spades on top, then take it with your right hand and place it face up on top of the pack.

The same procedure is carried out again. Double Lift to display the Ace of Hearts, then turn it face down and place the top card under the packet. Flip over the top card revealing the Ace of Hearts, as you say, **"This tells me the suit of your card wasn't a Heart."** Place this Ace face up on top of the pack.

The handling changes a little here for the next Ace. A single turnover is done to show the Ace of Diamonds. This Ace is taken in the right hand and displayed.



As you do this casually rotate the remaining double in your left hand so that the audience catch a glimpse of the Ace of Clubs (fig.3). Rotate your left hand palm up again and place the Ace of Diamonds face down on top of the left hand card(s). Immediately do a two-card Push Off, placing the double to the bottom. Flip over the top two cards as one to reveal the Ace of Diamonds back on top.

Remove the double with your right hand and place it face up on top of the pack, using similar patten as before. To conclude the routine, simply look at the remaining card in your hand and say to the spectator, **"You must have chosen a Club."** Let them reply before revealing the card in your hand as the actual selection!

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Angel Heart

This is a variation of Melvin LeHare's "Vernon, My Angel, Your Home" that appeared in *Abacus*. Melvin's trick was based on a Horowitz effect called "Look Homeward Angel."

Before commencing, remove the four Aces and place one Ace face down on top of the deck and the other three face up on the bottom. The order of the other three Aces is not important.

1. Give the deck a False Shuffle or False Cut (or both!) then take it into dealing grip. Invite a spectator to cut off about one third of the deck, turn it face up and place it on top. Ask him to repeat this procedure, but on this occasion to "cut deeper" so that he lifts off about twice as many cards as previously (this is the Balducci procedure). This section is also turned over before being replaced.



Spread the deck briefly between your hands to allow everyone to see what the cutting process has achieved. Some cards face up - some cards face down (photo), then square the cards again.

NOTE: This spread/display is important. Lay people have no conception of the condition of the cards following the cuts.

2. Announce that you will count the number of face up cards.

Deal cards onto the table counting aloud and stop once you have dealt the first face down card. Assume you have dealt twenty cards - nineteen face up and the twentieth card face down. Lift off the face down card from the dealt pile and show the face to the spectators. This will be the Ace of Hearts. Place the selection face down on the bottom of the undealt cards - that is, the section you are still holding, saying, **"I'll place the card at the lowest possible position...on the the bottom."**

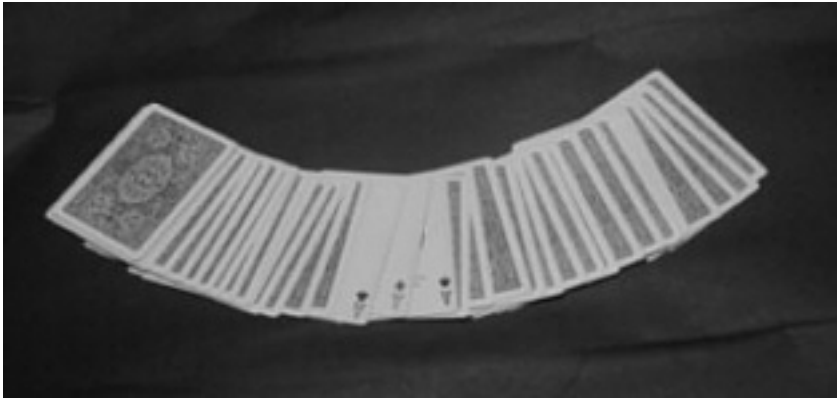
3. Pick up the cards from the table and place them face down on top of the lower section, but maintain a break between the two groups. Execute a half pass. This will bring the Ace of Hearts to a face up position directly below the top nineteen cards.

Snap your fingers as a magical gesture, then ask the spectator how many cards down his card

originally was. He will reply, "**Twenty.**" Count off twenty cards slowly and deliberately into a face down pile and everyone will be surprised to see the Ace of Hearts back at the twentieth position. But, this time it's face up.

4. Reach forward with your right hand, pick up the face up Ace and hand it to the spectator. As you do so, place your left thumb below the section in your left hand and secretly flip it over. Then immediately bring the right hand back and take hold of this section and drop it square on top of the face down pile on the table.

This action leaves the other three Aces face up within the face down deck. Ask the spectator to wave the Ace of Hearts over the deck, as if it was a magic wand.



Conclude by spreading the cards across the table revealing the other three Aces have magically reversed themselves in sympathy with the selected card (photo).

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Blending Bullets

Two *Blendomatic* cards are placed aside (two black Aces). A card is chosen (e.g. Ten of Hearts), returned to the pack and the pack shuffled. The magician tries to cut the chosen card to the top of the pack but fails, revealing instead, the Six of Hearts. The magician tries again but gets the Four of Hearts this time. Both these cards are placed between the *Blendomatic* cards and are given a squeeze. The subsequent blend produces the Ten of Hearts.

This is a version of Paul Harris' "Blendo." The trick includes ideas from Roy Walton and Ben Harris. This originally appeared in *Profile*, issue no.5.

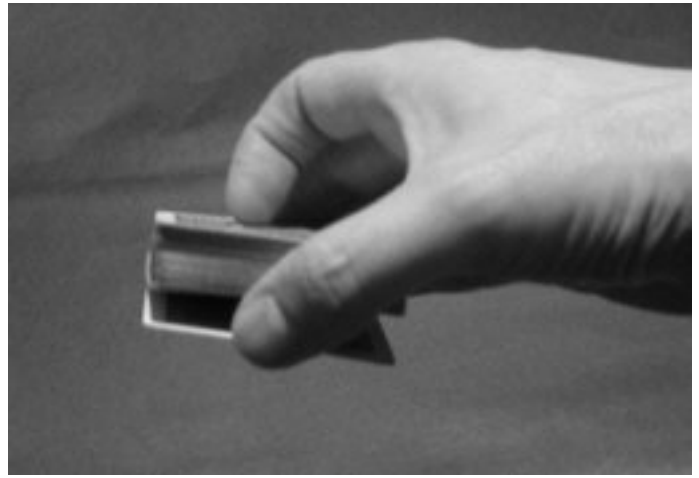
The following set up is required. Place the Four of Hearts on top of the pack. On the face of the pack place the Ten of Hearts, then the six of hearts, an indifferent card and finally the two black Aces. The Aces are at the face of the pack.

1. Hold the pack face up in the left hand and obtain a break under the upper three cards. Push over the face card to display the two black Aces, then square them again and lift off all three cards above the break (apparently two), keeping them square. The three face up cards are held in a Biddle Grip. Turn the pack face down, retaining it in left hand dealing grip.



2. With your left thumb, peel off the first Ace onto the pack and flip it face down. Now flip the remaining double card face down on top. Patter about these being the *Blendomatic* cards as you count off the top two cards - reversing their order - then place them into your outer breast pocket with the faces inwards . They should protrude for about an inch (photo).

3. Hold the pack in your right hand from above and secure a break above the bottom two cards with your right thumb (photo). Swing Cut the top half of the pack into your left hand then place the remaining half on top - transferring the break to your left little finger.



Riffle Force to the break (Ten of Hearts) and have the card returned to the same position. Execute a Pass or Double Undercut to bring the selection to the top of the pack with your stack remaining directly below.

4. Now carry out a False Cut claiming that you will attempt to cut to the selection. Execute a Double Lift and turn over to show the Six of Hearts.

Turn the double face down and deal the top card to the table (actually the Ten). Slip Cut the top card to the centre and Double Lift again to show the Four of Hearts. Turn the double face down and deal the top card (actually an Ace) on top of the previous card.

5. Place the pack aside and put the two tabled cards face down into your left hand. Your right hand now reaches for the two cards in your breast pocket. As you remove the protruding cards, your thumb pushes the card nearest your body down into the pocket and only the outer card is removed (top of pocket dodge). Without pause, place this card on top of the cards in your left hand. Immediately turn the top card face up - an Ace - and place it to the bottom of the packet. Turn the next card face up to show the other Ace and leave this on top.



Squeeze cards together and spread to reveal the actual selection - Ten of Hearts - magically blended from the two previous errors (photo).

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Campbell's Aces

This next trick is dedicated to the memory of the late Dave Campbell. Over 30 years ago Dave published a routine entitled "The Performing Aces." (*The Gen*, Vol.22, No.8, December 1966). At one point in Dave's routine the four Aces are placed face down into the middle of the pack. When the pack is spread a moment later, all four Aces have mysteriously turned face up. It was this phase of Dave's trick that inspired the following.

The basic plot here is the Hofzinser Ace Problem.

1. Begin by shuffling the pack then having a card chosen. The card is replaced and controlled to the top of the pack. Next turn the pack face up and spread through the cards. Look for four Aces and upjog each one as you come to it.

As you are doing this glimpse the top card of the pack (if this happens to be an Ace remove the four Kings instead). When all four Aces have been upjogged, they are removed with the right hand and turned face down. They are then placed to the rear of the pack.

2. Flip the pack face down into the left hand. The Aces are now face up on top with the pack face down below them. At this point the Ace of the same suit as the selection should be manoeuvred into the 4th position from top. In other words it should be back to back with the selection. Casually spread over the four Aces into your right hand to display them. As you do this secure a break with your left pinkie under the first face down card. The four Aces are now squared and everything above the break is lifted off with your right hand in a Biddle grip.

The pack is placed onto the table in front of the spectator.

3. Each Ace is now peeled off with the left thumb into the left hand dealing grip. The 4th Ace is a double and is simply placed onto the others.



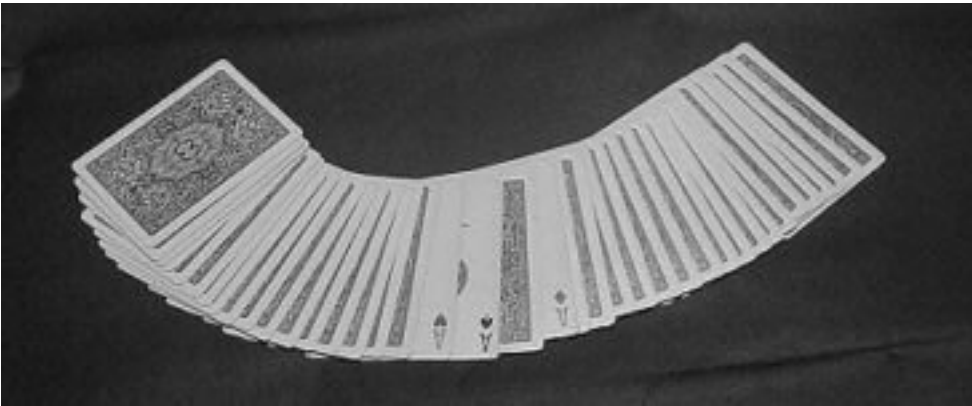
The packet is now turned face down and held by the left hand in a pinch grip, just as if you were about to do an Elmsley Count. With your right hand, peel off the 1st card into the right hand dealing grip (photo). The 2nd card is taken on top of the first. When you come over to take the 3rd card the left thumb pushes over two cards as one and these are taken into the right hand. The 4th card is taken on top of all.

You have quite clearly shown all four Aces back, and front.

4. Take the packet face down into left hand dealing grip. The right hand comes over to square the packet. As this is done, you look the spectator in the eye and ask him to cut the pack in half. As he does this, the right thumb has secured a break under the top card of the packet and the left hand carries out a Half Pass with all the cards below the top card.

When the spectator has finished his/her task, the packet in your hands is dropped onto either tabled half.

5. Ask the spectator to pick up the other half and drop it onto the Ace packet sandwiching it in the middle of the pack. Explain to the spectator that you will attempt to make three of the Aces turn face up, while one Ace will remain face down.



At this point the pack spread across the table. Sure enough, three Aces have turned face up and one remains face down (photo). Ask the spectator what the suit of their card was.

If he says Clubs, for example, you say, "**That's strange! The Ace of Clubs appears to be the only Ace that remains face down.**" After a suitable pause ask the spectator for the name of their card in full. You now end the routine by turning the face down card amongst the Aces face up to reveal the actual selection.

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I m m e d i a t e A c e S p e l l

You hand out the pack to a spectator for shuffling. You now take back the pack and immediately spell to each of the four Aces, with the spectator spelling to the final Ace.

1. Cull the four Aces to the top of the pack so they are in S, H, C, D order, with Spades being the top card of the deck (photo).



As you begin the performance, the four Aces are palmed into your right hand as you give out the deck for shuffling with your left hand.

When you retrieve the pack, the Aces are secretly added back on top.

2. You now spell out **A-C-E O-F D-I-A-M-O-N-D-S** dealing one card for each letter into a face down pile on the table. The first three cards (A-C-E) are dealt fairly, however, you must then Second Deal all the remaining cards until you reach the final letter, 'S.' The card on the letter 'S' is dealt fairly face up to reveal the Ace of Diamonds. Leave the Ace of Diamonds face up on the table.

Gather up the dealt pile and replace them on top of the deck. You are now set to spell the remaining Aces fairly.

3. Explain you will now spell out the other red Ace.

Spell out **A-C-E O-F H-E-A-R-T-S** exactly as before but without any false dealing. Turn up the card on the letter 'S,' to reveal the Ace of Hearts.

Gather up the dealt cards and replace them on top of the deck.

4. Spell out the **A-C-E O-F S-P-A-D-E-S** turning up the last card to reveal the Ace of Spades.

Replace the dealt pile of cards back on to the top of the deck.

5. Hand the deck to a spectator for him to spell the **A-C-E O-F C-L-U-B-S** and of course the last card dealt will be the Ace of Clubs.

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Imogen

This routine is not intended to be a blockbusting magician fooler, but it may appeal to some. Come to think about it, even if it doesn't fool magicians, it may set them pondering over variations and stuff, so that can't be bad. It is a strong effect requiring minimum sleight of hand.

A simple set-up of the top 11 cards of the pack is required:

5C - QD - 5S - QS - X - X - X - X - QH - X - 5H

The X cards are of course random cards. The Five of Diamonds and Queen of Clubs should be removed from the pack, and one of them placed in your jacket pocket and the other placed into the card case. These two cards can be placed anywhere, so you can decide where you would like to produce them from, but do remember which card is where.

1. Begin by giving the pack a False Shuffle, then give the pack a cut and retain a break between the two halves. Riffle Force to break and give the Five of Clubs and Queen of Diamonds to a spectator. Reassemble the pack with your set-up intact and on top. The Riffle Force is only a suggestion and any Force which retains your stack can be used.

2. Ask the spectator to lay his two selection face up on the table (photo). Point out that although the spectator has selected the Queen of Diamonds and Five of Clubs, two entirely different (imaginary) cards can be created by switching the suits around.



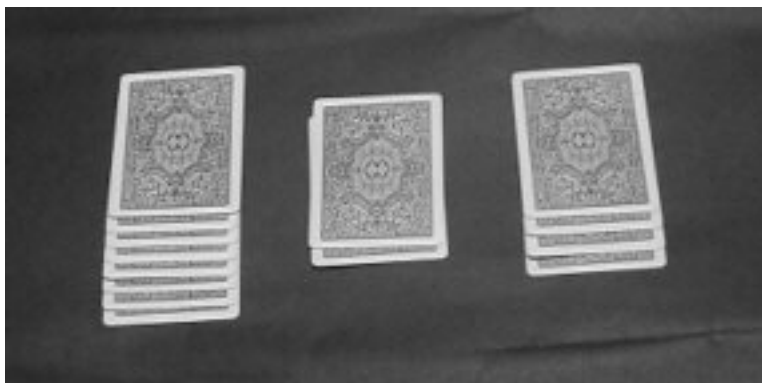
So, instead of the Queen of Diamonds and the Five of Clubs you could create the Queen of Clubs and the Five of Diamonds. Once the spectator understands what you are getting at, ask him to "create" an entirely new -imaginary - card using the suits and values of his freely selected cards.

He must, of course imagine either the Five of Diamonds or the Queen of Clubs. This creation he keeps to himself for the time being.

3. Once he has made a choice, have him return the two cards to the pack. Contrive to have the Five of Clubs returned above the Queen of Diamonds and both on top of the stack. Control everything so that the stack is back on top of the pack. Thus the Five of Clubs is the top card and

the Queen of Diamonds is second. Give the pack a further Jog Shuffle adding three cards on top of all.

4. Now give the pack to the spectator and ask him to name his imagined card. Whichever card he names, have him spell that card by dealing one card for each letter forming three separate piles for each word.



For example if he names the Five of Diamonds he spells **F-I-V-E** into one pile. The card on the letter 'E' becomes the top card of this pile. He then spells **O-F** to form a second pile and finally **D-I-A-M-O-N-D-S** into a third pile

(Cards shown spread for descriptive purposes only).

5. Turn over the top card of each pile to reveal the three mates of the imaginary card (photo). Explain to the spectator that their imaginary card did not turn up because it has vanished from the pack!



You now offer proof of its disappearance by removing the appropriate card from wherever you placed it prior to the commencement of the trick.

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One Too Many

Edward Victor's "Eleven Card Trick" was the starting point for this routine. The Victor routine can be found in *Willane's Methods for Miracles*, number 6.

1. Shuffle the deck and have a card chosen. The card is returned and controlled to the top, during which you obtain a break under the top three cards.

2. Palm off the top three cards into your right hand, then give the deck to the spectator and ask her to remove three cards from different positions in the deck.

Each time she decides on a card have her place it into your left hand. After she places the second card into your left hand come over with your right hand and add on the palmed cards, then have her place the third card on top of all.

Ask her to place the deck onto the table in front of you.

3. State, "**Three cards and three cards only,**" as you Elmsley Count the cards as four. "**You must have given me one too many,**" you say.

Remove the top card and place it on top of the deck.

4. Again Elmsley Count the cards - you've still got four. Once again remove the top and place it on top of the deck.

5. Again state, "**Three cards, no more.**" This time count the cards fairly using the same actions as the Elmsley Count. Once again you have four cards.

Say: "**I can't do this trick with four cards.**" Take off the top card and place it on top of the deck.

6. Three cards remain in your hand. Elmsley Count these three cards - four again!

Explain that all this is getting ridiculous. Take off the top two cards as one and place them on top of the deck.

7. Ask the spectator to hold out her hand, as you say, "**O.K. You count the cards.**"

Place the single card onto her palm, for a split second she will attempt to count, only to find she's holding one card. Finish off by saying: "**Must be yours!**"

CREDITS

The use of the Elmsley Count for a Four Card Repeat sequence was put to good use by Jerry Sadowitz in his trick "007 and Counting." See *Contemporary Card Magic* (Breese Books, 1984) and *CardZones* (Breese Books, 2001). Although the effect described here is completely different, both tricks are of similar construction.

For other related effects, see *Williamson's Wonders* by David Williamson and *The Spring of 52* by Lewis Jones ("Son of Randominium").

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Pass the Sandwich

This trick was worked out after reading Jim Swain's "Passing Along the Vanishing Aces."

As the title suggests a single sandwich effect is what takes place here.

1. Run through the deck and pick out the two black Aces and place them face up on top of the deck. Now do a little Braue Addition to switch out one of the Ace for an indifferent card. This is, briefly, as follows:

Lift off the top three cards (apparently only two) then peel off the uppermost Ace onto the deck, the flip it face down. Immediately drop the remaining double on top and then flip the second ace face down. Finally deal the top two cards onto the table reversing their order.

POSITION CHECK: On the table you have one black Ace and on top of that you have one odd card, unknown to the spectators the other black Ace is on top of the deck.

2. Spread the deck and have a card chosen, then have the selection replaced and controlled to the top with a black Ace below it.

3. Drop the deck onto the assumed Aces, then pick the deck up and hold it in right hand Biddle grip. Casually show the bottom card - an Ace - then bring the deck down on to the left thumb and swivel out the Ace so it comes round the left side of the deck and lands on top face up (see photos below).



Obtain a break below the third card from the top. Now execute a Pass at the break. The first Ace vanishes.

4. Again hold the deck in the right hand Biddle grip and show the bottom card of the deck, the other Ace. Swivel it out and around so it ends face up on top of the deck. Obtain a break

anywhere near the middle of the deck and execute a Pass. The second Ace vanishes.

Finally, spread the deck and show the sandwich in the middle. Ask the spectator to name his selection, then turn over the trapped card to finish.

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Repulsion

The four Queens are shown and placed on the table. Two cards are selected and lost in the deck. The deck is tapped with the Queens and the first selection rises to the top. This card is then placed among the Queens, whereupon it instantly vanishes and reappears inside your pocket. This is repeated with the second selection. You finish clean.

This is a variation of Alex Elmsley's "Repulsive Aces" that appeared in *The Collected Works of Alex Elmsley*, Vol.1.

1. Run through the deck and throw out the four Queens making sure they are in red, red, black, black order. Have two cards selected, returned and controlled to the top of the deck.

2. Pick up the Queens and place them face up on top of the deck, then spread the cards to display the four Queens (photo). As you do so, catch a break below the first face down card. Square up the cards and, with your right hand, lift off all the cards above the break - plus one more card - maintaining a break between it and the packet. The cards are held in a Biddle grip.



3. Now do a modified Braue Addition, as follows:

- a) Peel off the first Queen and flip it face down onto the deck - as it falls face down let the card below the thumb break fall square on top.
- b) Peel off the 2nd Queen and flip it face down
- c) Peel off the 3rd Queen and flip it face down, dropping the final double (Queen and hidden card) on top - flip the last Queen face down.

4. Remove the top four cards and place the deck on the table. Casually look at them, glimpsing the first selection. You are going to miscall this card later. Tap the top of the deck with the four cards, then say, **"One of your cards has risen to the top of the deck."** Pick off the top card and casually flash the face, then look at it yourself and name it.

Push this face down card among the Queens - second from top - then turn the packet face up and carry out an Elmsley Count to show that the card has vanished. Turn the cards face down. Palm off the top two cards with your right hand, then place your hand into your right jacket

pocket and produce the card nearest the palm leaving the other card behind.

5. Again tap the top of the deck with the Queens and say, "**The second card has now risen to the top.**" Pick off the top card, but do not show its face or you will look a fool because this card is a Queen. As you look at the card, miscall it as the card you glimpsed earlier. Now push it among the Queens - again it goes second from top.

Keep the cards face down and carry out any Four as Five Count (The Elmsley Ever-change Count is ideal for this). Ask the spectator to hold out his hand then place the cards onto his hand. Ask him to give the cards a squeeze, then to count then onto the table, or spread them. The second card has vanished. You now show your hand empty and remove the card from your pocket to conclude.

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Flight Path

By Roy Walton

When I showed Roy Walton the previous effect, "Repulsion," he immediately worked out a more streamlined handling. It appears here with his kind permission.

As with the previous routine, the basic premise belongs to Alex Elmsley (See Repulsive Aces, *The Collected Works of Alex Elmsley*, Vol.1)

1. Begin by removing the four Queens from the pack. Hold two Queens face down in each hand, ensuring that each pair contains a black and a red Queen with each set in the same colour sequence. Raise your hands upwards so that the audience can see the faces of the Queens then lower your hands again. Place one pair on top of the other and square the four cards. As you do so, obtain a right thumb break under the top Queen at the inner end.

Release the left hand grip so the four cards remain held by the right hand in a Biddle grip - with the break maintained by your thumb.

2. Ask the spectator to pick up the pack and shuffle it. After he has done that, tell him to look through and remove any card he wishes, and to remember it. Hold out your left hand and ask him to place his selection face down on your outstretched hand.

You are about to switch the first selection for one of the Queens. Don't worry about this switch. It is very simple to do and well-covered by in-built misdirection. Ask the spectator to look through the deck again and to remove and remember a second card.



As soon as the spectator starts to do this, your right hand casually approaches the left hand (photo).



The moment the right hand packet is directly over the selection, release all the cards below the break so they land square on top (photo).



Then, without pause, move the right hand forward with the remaining single card (photo) and drop it on the table.

From an audience viewpoint, you have four face down queens in your left hand and the first selection lies face down on the table.

3. With your right hand take the second selection from the spectator and place it on top of the Queen packet so that it is injogged for about one inch. Take hold of the packet with the right hand, fingers above and thumb below, along the right long side, then tilt it towards you so that you can see the face (photo).



The reason for this, from the spectator's viewpoint, is so that you can see the card he selected. Name the injogged card, but also remember the card at the face. Move the packet back to the horizontal position and give the packet a cut, cutting the bottom two cards to the top. Square up the packet after you do that.

4. Turn the packet face up and Elmsley Count to show the chosen card has vanished. One Queen

is counted twice but this is never noticed as all focus is on the selection (or lack of!). Flip the packet face down and casually spread to show four backs. The last two cards are held as one. As you square the cards, secure a break under the top two cards with the left little finger.

5. As you speculate on the whereabouts of the vanished card, Palm off the top two cards into your right hand and immediately retain the remaining three - held from above in a Biddle grip - in the same hand. The packet of three cards is now placed on top of the tabled card, but keep it deliberately off-set slightly. The right hand now enters the right hand trouser pocket, leaves behind the card nearest the palm and comes out with the card nearest the body. This, of course, is the card you vanished seconds earlier. Drop this card face up onto the table.

6. Square up the tabled packet of cards and tip them towards you to look at the face card. Miscall this card as the one you glimpsed earlier then tilt the cards face down again. Give the packet a cut - cutting one card from top to face - then flip the packet face up. This time count the cards fairly, emulating an Elmsley count. The second selection has vanished.

Deal the Queens one at a time onto the table. Finally, show your right hand empty then reach into your pocket and remove the second selected card.

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Thought Provoked

Two spectators are each given a small packet of cards. They both look at their cards and think of any one. Each of the thought of cards are revealed in a surprising manner.

To begin this effect you have to arrange a twelve card stack. Remove from the pack the following cards:

4H - 7S - 5D - QD - 10C - 5C - QS - KD - 8D - 6C - 2H - 5S

Place the packet, in the above order, on top of the pack. The 4H will be the top card of the pack.

1. Begin by removing the two red Aces and dropping them face up onto the table. The Aces will be known as the ***Thought Locators***. False Shuffle the pack then casually push off a few cards from the top. Actually six cards are pushed off. These cards are given to a spectator on your right.

Push off another six cards and give these to a spectator on your left.

2. Tell them both to look at their cards and to think of any one they like. Explain that you really want them to cement the image of their card in their mind. Continue, saying that one way of doing this is to spell out the name of their card one card per letter. That is to transfer one card from the top of their packet to the bottom of the packet for each letter. At this point it is advisable to cut off a small packet from the main pack and give them a quick demonstration. Make sure they don't forget the word 'of' as in the Ace of Clubs.

Once both spectators have finished their tasks, take the right hand spectator's packet and place it into your left hand. Now take the left hand spectators packet and place it on top of the cards in your left hand. You now hold a combined packet of 12 cards.

3. Pick up the *Thought Locators* and place one on top of the packet and one on the bottom of the packet. Explain that you will now send the 'Thought Locators.' into the packet in search of their thoughts.

To complete the trick all you have to do is to give the packet three Reverse Faros with this stipulation; after the first Reverse Faro, the outjogged cards are stripped out and placed on top of the packet. The same applies to the second Reverse Faro. For the third Reverse Faro, the outjogged cards are stripped out and placed on the bottom.

Note:

To do a Reverse Faro you simply outjog every second card (photo), then strip out the outjogged cards and place these cards above, or below, the others.



Finally, spread the packet to show that the *Thought Locators* have trapped the thought-of cards.

CREDIT

The Thought Locating theme used in this trick belongs to Peter Duffie.

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Transmutation

There's plenty of magical content in this routine. It combines "The Ambitious Card" with "Dr. Daley's Last Trick" and concludes with Roy Walton's "Oil & Queens" ending. Precedents to this are: "Aces-Red and Black" by Arthur Hastings (*Ibidem*, page 239), and an apparent variation by Steve Freeman, "Black Aces-Red Kings" (*Hierophant*, page 279). I hope you find this of some interest.

Start off by placing the two black Aces on top of the pack, under these place the two red Queens and under these place the two red Aces. So from the top of the pack down you should have, black Ace, black Ace, red Queen, red Queen, red Ace, red Ace. With the pack arranged in this manner we can now begin the effect proper.

1. Before drawing attention to the pack, the top six cards are turned face up on top and a break is held below these cards with your left pinkie.

The top three cards are now spread to show two red Aces, followed by two red Queens. Your left hand retains the two red Queens on top of the pack as your right hand removes and displays the two red Aces (photo).



2. Ask the spectator to hold out his/her hand. The two red Aces are revolved face down and placed onto the spectator's palm. Tell the spectator to place his/her other hand on top of the Aces. Your right hand is now free to come over to the pack. Everything above your break is now flipped face down. The top two cards of the pack are taken off into your right hand. The pack is now placed onto the table and is no longer required. Transfer the assumed Queens into the left hand.

3. Explain to the spectator that the red Queens are very magical cards. As this is being said, ask the spectator to open her hand a little. With your right hand you now reach in and remove one of the Aces. Turn it face up and show it, then turn it face down again and place it on top of the two apparent Queens in your left hand.

The top two cards of this packet are pushed off as one and placed below the single card. As you do this, say, **"If I place a red Ace below the Queens and give the cards a shake, it rises up through the Queens and appears on top."** Execute a Double Lift to show the red Ace on top

then flip double face down again.

4. Take the top card off with your right hand. Ask the spectator to separate his/her palms again and replace the Ace. As this Ace is being replaced remove the other Ace then turn it face up to show it. Turn it face down and place it on top of the left hand cards. The same sequence is repeated one more time. That is; push off a double place it below then do a Double Turnover to show it back on top.

Remove the top card as before and place it back between the spectators palms. At this, tell the spectator to squeeze the red Aces. As they do this, turn over the cards in your hand to show the red Aces.

Finally, say, **"If I have the Aces you must have the..."** (Pause here and wait for an answer).

Usually they will say the Queens, at this point the spectator is allowed to turn over the cards to reveal, not the Queens, but the two black Aces!

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Travelling PDQ

Three selected cards travel to three different pockets.

Before you begin, place any card in your left jacket pocket and any card in your outer breast pocket, both with backs outwards.

1. Ask someone to shuffle the cards.

2. Three spectators are about to choose cards. These three people will be in front of you, but not too close together. Run your left thumb down the left side of the deck asking the spectator in the middle to call stop. Break the deck at that point and ask him to remember the bottom card of the upper half.

Replace this half doing the Kelly/Ovette move controlling the selection to the bottom.

Approach the spectator on the right and ask him to call stop, carry out the same procedure but this time do not control the selection to the bottom, just replace the upper half maintaining a break below the selection.

Approach the spectator on the left and ask him to call stop only this time Riffle Force the card above the break on him (same card as before). As you replace the upper half do the Kelly/Ovette move controlling the selection to the bottom.

Casually shuffle the cards bringing the bottom two cards to the top reversing their order. If you can injog the 2nd last card of the shuffle it makes the next move easier to get into.

3. Palm the top two cards into your right hand, keeping hold of the deck with the same hand. Casually show your left hand empty and reach into your left jacket pocket and remove the card that's already there, bringing it out with its back towards the audience. Meanwhile, your right hand places the deck on the table, then the right hand goes to right jacket pocket and removes the card nearest the palm, leaving the other card behind.

For a second only the right hand card is placed into the left hand in front of the card already there.

Your right hand moves up to the outer breast pocket and pulls that card half way out (photo), then pushes the card back down again.

Now, the right hand goes back to left hand and takes the outer card (that is, the other card), then both hands replace their cards back into your jacket pockets, right hand card going back nearest your body.

Both cards have thus been swapped over.



4. Now pick up the deck as you say, "**These are not just any cards, look!**" Spread the deck face up across the table.

They can now see that their cards are no longer in the deck.

5. Now produce the selections from your pockets like this:

Your left hand goes to left hand jacket pocket and removes its card, while your right hand goes to outer breast pocket and removes its card - place this card onto the card in your left hand, both faces are shown. Name both these cards and Say, "**That's your card and your card,**" pointing to spectators on the left and right.

Your right hand now goes to right jacket pocket and removes its outer card saying, and that's your card pointing to the spectator in the middle, place this card onto the two in your left hand and drop all three onto the table to end.

END NOTES

As you will have noticed this routine relies on the left hand and right hand spectators unwittingly choosing the same card.

The crucial point in the routine is when you show the faces of the cards that are in the left jacket pocket and the outer breast pocket, always place these cards side by side and show them together. That way, each spectator assumes that the odd card is the other spectator's.

This principle dates back to "The Smith Myth" (Fetsch) and is perhaps even older. That, combined with Peter Duffie's "Double Fantasy" pocket dodge (*Close-up to the Point & CardZones*), I believe makes for a very direct Travellers routine.

The original "Travellers" was published by Dai Vernon in *The Stars of Magic* series.

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Triola

This routine is a particular favourite of mine. Karl Fulves gets credit for the basic concept in this trick. (See "Optical Aces" in *Pallbearers Review*).

1. If your pack has two Jokers in it remove them and drop them face up on the table. If you don't have Jokers use the two black Aces instead.
2. The pack is now spread face down and three spectators each touch the back of any card they wish. As each card is touched it is upjogged. Once three cards have been touched, strip them out using your right hand. The spectators are now shown the cards they touched. They must remember them.
3. At this point the cards have to be replaced into the pack and controlled to the top. It's up to you how you do this. I use a Multiple Shift.
4. Now pick up the two Jokers from the table with your right hand. As you display them, set the top card of the pack in readiness for TILT. The two Jokers are now revolved face down. Using your right hand you apparently push the Jokers into the middle of the pack - of course they actually go below the top card.
5. Say, **"In order to find all three selected cards I have to first test the magical abilities of the Jokers. To do this, all I have to do is riffle the pack and the Jokers will rise to the top."**
As this is said, your right hand removes the top two cards of the pack as one and turns them face up. Use this Double card to flip over the next card. The two Jokers have risen to the top. Place the single card on top of the double card in your right hand. As this is being done a break is secured under the top two cards of the pack (I use a Pinkie Count). Place the right hand cards on top of the pack and shift everything above your break over to the right a little so they are sidejogged. This procedure is done with your right hand gripping the packet in Biddle grip.
6. There is currently a packet of cards sidejogged on top of the pack. This sidejogged packet is held in place by your left thumb. The audience believe these to be the two jokers. These two Jokers will now be snapped and a card will instantly appear between them. Here's how:

The right hand re-grips the sidejogged cards at the right side in a pinch grip - fingers below and thumb on top (photo.1).



The packet is now revolved over - bookwise - to the left (photo.2).



Just as the packet becomes vertical to the pack the right thumb squeezes and pushes everything above the bottom card to the left (photo.3).



All cards except the bottom one are hinged down on to the pack. As this is happening the remaining card is snapped over with your right hand.

You are left with a single face down card in your right hand and a face up selection on top of the pack (photo.4).



This face up selection is pushed off with your left thumb and taken under the right hand card in an outjogged position. The next face down card is pushed off the top of the pack and taken under the

two in your right hand.

A selected card has mysteriously appeared between the two Jokers. Your right hand now approaches the table with its three cards and the centre face up card is allowed to drop onto the table.

At this point, say, "**That's one of the cards...now, finding the other two is much easier.**" To conclude give the two cards in your right hand a little snap and turn them over to show the other two selections.

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